



VOLAR

Chat, story, and adventure — for the GCC & MENA

The problem

Generic AI companions aren't built for MENA

1

Cultural mismatch

Most companion apps default to Western or romance-first framing that doesn't fit regional norms.

2

Regulatory risk

Romance-oriented AI chat carries real compliance concerns across Gulf jurisdictions.

3

No real alternative

Few products offer genuinely respectful, MENA-grounded interactive storytelling today.

The solution

Four original, culturally-grounded characters

K

Kaysan

The Detective

MYSTERY

O

Omar

The Mentor

MENTORSHIP

E

Elizit

The Young Leader

LEADERSHIP

L

Layla

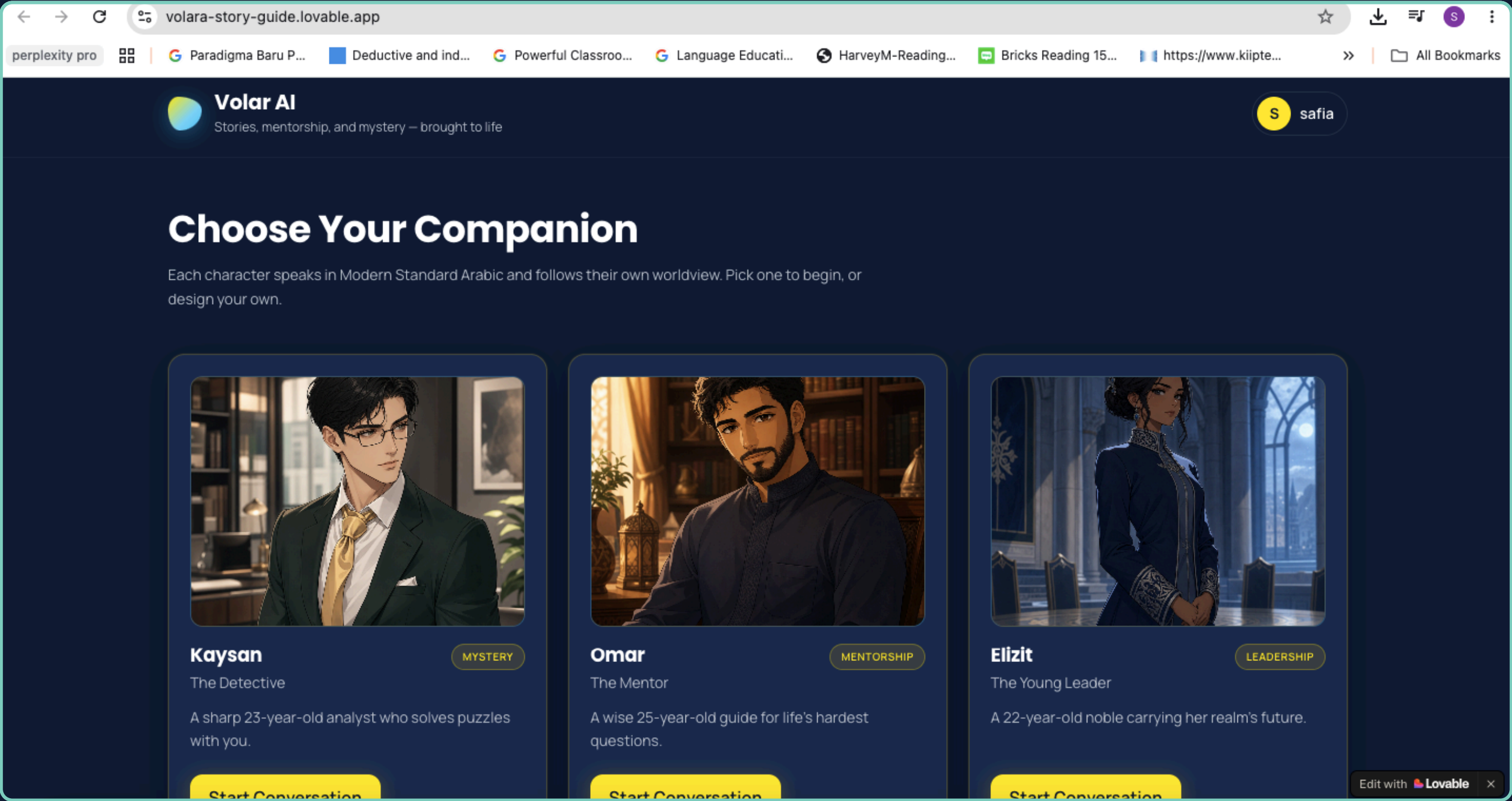
The Storyteller-Scholar

STORYTELLING

Each speaks fluent Modern Standard Arabic, each with a built-in guardrail redirecting romantic or flirtatious dialogue back in-character.

Built, not just planned

A live, working product — not a mockup or a deck



Real features

Custom character creation

Users design their own character in minutes, inheriting the same guardrails by default.

“Illustrate this moment”

Turns a specific chat exchange into a scene image, using the character's own reference portrait for visual consistency.

Two-tone conversation style

Formal Fusha or Warm Fusha, switchable mid-conversation without changing the character's core personality.

Guardrails built in, not bolted on

A design principle, not a feature

Every character

Including future user-created ones, inherits the same non-romantic guardrail by default.

Every image

The illustration feature refuses romantic or suggestive moments, showing a neutral scene instead.

No confidential framing

No intimate or private-chat language anywhere in the product.

Why this market, why now

\$48B

Global AI companion market in 2026, growing
~31% a year

24%

Annual growth rate for MEA specifically —
fastest of any region

55%

Of MENA's population is under 30 — the core
audience for interactive AI storytelling

The gap

MENA is currently the smallest region in this market — not because demand is low, but because almost every major AI companion product is built English-first, for Western norms. Arabic-speaking, mobile-first users are underserved by design, not by accident.

Why I'm building this

Safia Raghoui — Commercial founder



I audited this exact category professionally

Pre-launch character strategy, persona architecture, and brand-safety guardrails for a U.S.-market AI companion platform at Scatter Lab.



7+ years building GCC market entry from zero

Hyperconnect, SpoonLabs — launch infrastructure and partnerships across Saudi Arabia and the UAE, repeatedly, on tight timelines.



I build, not just strategize

Volar AI, Majlis AI, and Accord AI are all independently designed, tested, and shipped — no engineering team.

What's next

Where this goes from here

01

Full account system

Real sign-in and cross-device persistence for characters and chat history.

02

More characters

Expanding the original cast across more genres.

03

Khaleeji dialect

Exploring a more casual, regionally-specific character voice.

04

Community

User character sharing, with the same guardrails preserved.



What I'm looking for

A technical co-founder to build alongside — and ten weeks to prove this is a real, fundable company, not just a product I built alone.

- Built solo, AI-assisted — no engineering team
- Live product, tested end-to-end
- Grounded in 7+ years of GCC market experience